

MindEase

Mental Health Companion -- Redesigned v2.0

This document defines the product requirements and new visual direction for MindEase v2.0 -- a mental health companion for college students. All existing features and OWASP security controls are preserved; the redesign introduces a complete design system under the aesthetic concept **Soft Clinical Warmth**: light-mode, organic, editorial, and human.

VERSION	OWNER	STATUS	DATE
2.0 -- Redesign	MindEase Product Team	Draft for Review	February 2026

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Executive Summary

MindEase is a web-based mental health companion designed for college students in India. The v1.x build delivers a fully-functional AI chat interface, mood tracking, therapy finder, and curated self-help resources -- all hardened to OWASP Top 10 standards.

MindEase v2.0 preserves every feature and security control from v1.x while introducing a complete visual redesign under the **Soft Clinical Warmth** aesthetic: a light-mode, editorial, organic design system that feels simultaneously professional, approachable, and safe.

Why Redesign?

Current State Problems

- * Dark mode only -- alienating for users in distress
- * Generic dark aesthetic lacks warmth or identity
- * Low contrast in muted states fails WCAG AA
- * No design system -- inconsistent spacing and type
- * Monochrome palette reduces information hierarchy

v2.0 Goals

- * Warm light-mode default with optional dark mode
- * Unique, recognisable visual identity
- * WCAG AA compliance across all surfaces
- * Complete design token system for consistency
- * Semantic accent palette with clear meaning

Key Constraint -- No Feature Regression

- * All features from v1.x must be fully preserved in v2.0.
- * All OWASP security controls remain unchanged and untouched.
- * The redesign is a purely visual and interaction layer change.
- * CSP, rate limiting, input validation, XSS mitigations are non-negotiable.

Design Vision -- Soft Clinical Warmth

The guiding aesthetic concept is **Soft Clinical Warmth**. This direction balances clinical precision with human warmth. The result feels like a well-designed therapist's space -- calm, professional, and genuinely inviting.

The Three Aesthetic Pillars

PILLAR	DESCRIPTION	DESIGN EXPRESSION
Organic Warmth	Feels human, not digital. Avoids cold blues.	Parchment backgrounds, amber accents, display serif type
Editorial Clarity	Structured but not clinical. Strong type hierarchy.	Generous whitespace, clear heading scale, restrained colour
Quiet Confidence	The UI never shouts. Interactions feel considered.	Subtle transitions, muted shadows, measured micro-interactions

Reference Aesthetic Directions

REFERENCE	WHAT WE BORROW	WHAT WE AVOID
Notion	Editorial whitespace, clean type hierarchy, minimal chrome	Document-first coldness -- we need human warmth
Calm App	Organic palette, soothing tones, breathing room	Gradient-heavy overdesign -- we stay restrained
Linear	Precision spacing, strong visual hierarchy	Its dark-mode coldness and startup identity
Lush	Warm parchment, editorial treatment	Decorative excess -- ours is functional first

Emotional Tone Goals

How it SHOULD feel

- * Safe -- private, judgement-free
- * Grounded -- calm, not anxious
- * Warm -- human, not algorithmic
- * Credible -- professional enough to trust
- * Accessible -- approachable for first-timers

What it should NOT feel

- * Clinical or cold -- not a hospital
- * Gamified -- no streak pressure
- * Overwhelming -- no notification anxiety
- * Infantilising -- not cartoonish
- * Dark and heavy -- avoid crisis aesthetics

Design System and Tokens

Colour System

A warm, semantic colour palette. Light mode is default. All text/background combinations meet WCAG AA (4.5:1 body, 3:1 large text).

TOKEN	HEX	USAGE	CONTRAST
c-bg	#FAFAF8	Page background	--
c-surface	#F2F0EB	Cards, panels, modals	--
c-border	#E0DDD7	Dividers and outlines	--
c-text	#1A1917	Primary body text	16.8:1
c-text-muted	#6E6A63	Labels, captions, placeholders	5.1:1
c-accent	#3D7A5F	Primary CTA, links, focus states	4.7:1
c-amber	#C17B4A	Secondary actions, positive mood	3.2:1*
c-lavender	#7A5EA7	Tertiary accent, calm mood	4.6:1
c-crisis	#C0392B	Crisis alerts only -- never decorative	5.8:1

* Amber used only at 14px+ large text where 3:1 is acceptable per WCAG AA.

Typography

ROLE	FONT FAMILY	WEIGHTS	USAGE	SIZE RANGE
Display	DM Serif Display	400	Page titles, hero moments, emotional statements	28--52px
UI / Body	DM Sans	300, 400, 500, 600	All UI labels, body copy, inputs, navigation	12--18px
Mono	DM Mono	400	Timestamps, reference numbers, crisis hotlines	11--13px

Spacing, Radius, and Elevation Tokens

TOKEN	VALUE	USAGE
space-1	4px	Minimum gap between inline elements

space-2	8px	Tight component padding
space-4	16px	Card padding, form field gaps
space-6	24px	Section padding, panel gutters
radius-sm	6px	Chips, tags, small badges
radius-md	12px	Inputs, buttons, time slots
radius-lg	20px	Cards, modals, main panels
radius-full	9999px	Pills, avatar circles, toggles
shadow-sm	0 1px 4px rgba(26,25,23,.06)	Cards at rest
shadow-md	0 4px 16px rgba(26,25,23,.10)	Modals, active dropdowns

04 / FEATURE SPECIFICATIONS

Feature Specifications

All five features from v1.x are preserved. Each is documented with its current treatment and v2.0 visual redesign.

F1 -- AI Chat Interface

ATTRIBUTE	CURRENT v1.x	REDESIGNED v2.0
Background	Dark #0d1117	Warm parchment c-bg with subtle grain texture
User bubble	Blue-tinted dark	Sage tint rgba(61,122,95,0.10), rounded top-right corner
Bot bubble	Dark surface card	c-surface, 1px c-border, shadow-sm, rounded top-left corner
Mood tag	Inline badge	Pill chip below response, colour-coded by sentiment
Wellness tip	Green-tinted card	Inset card, 3px sage left-rule, DM Serif Display heading
Crisis card	Red-border block	Full-width alert, c-crisis border, DM Mono hotline numbers
Input area	Dark surface, blue focus	White surface, 2px c-accent focus ring, no box-shadow
Quick prompts	Chip row	Scrollable pills, parchment fill, sage border on hover

F2 -- Mood Tracking and Check-in

ATTRIBUTE	CURRENT v1.x	REDESIGNED v2.0
Mood chart	Dark bar chart	Organic area chart on parchment, sage fill, amber peak highlight
Check-in card	Emoji button grid	Mood selector row, 2px c-accent border on selected, c-accent label
Stat cards	Dark surface	White card, DM Serif Display numerals, muted caption, thin border
Submit	Blue accent button	Full-width sage button, 12px radius, 600 weight

F3 -- Therapy Finder

ATTRIBUTE	CURRENT v1.x	REDESIGNED v2.0
Search bar	Dark input	White surface, sage focus ring, amber magnifier icon

Filter chips	Dark toggle buttons	Pill toggles; active: sage fill, white text; inactive: c-surface
Provider card	Dark card grid	White card, 20px radius, shadow-sm to shadow-md on hover, -4px lift
Free badge	Teal badge	Sage-tinted pill with leaf icon
Schedule btn	Accent button	Sage primary, outline secondary, full radius

F4 -- Self-Help Resources

ATTRIBUTE	CURRENT v1.x	REDESIGNED v2.0
Resource card	Dark grid card	White card, line-art icon, DM Serif Display title
Category tag	Per-category colour pill	Semantic tint system: sage/amber/lavender by category type
Card hover	Border colour change	-4px translateY lift + shadow-md, 200ms ease-out

F5 -- Appointment Booking Modal

ATTRIBUTE	CURRENT v1.x	REDESIGNED v2.0
Modal overlay	Dark blur	Warm rgba(26,25,23,0.45) + 6px blur
Modal surface	Dark card	White, 24px radius, shadow-md, 520px max-width
Form inputs	Dark, blue focus	White, sage 2px focus ring, crisis-red error state
Time slots	3-col dark grid	White pills, sage selected, amber hover, 8px radius
Confirm btn	Blue accent	Full-width sage, 12px radius, DM Sans 600
Validation	Red text below	Red border ring + error icon + aria-describedby

Screen-by-Screen UI Specifications

Screen 1 -- Global Application Shell

Sidebar (260px fixed width)

- * Background: c-surface, 1px right border c-border
- * Logo: DM Serif Display, leaf SVG icon in sage
- * Nav items: 40px height, 10px radius, active: sage tint
- * Mood badge at bottom: c-bg card, thin sage progress bar
- * Hover transitions: 180ms ease-out on background-color

Main Content Area (flex-1)

- * Tab bar: c-surface, 1px bottom border, 16px padding
- * Active tab: 2px bottom border c-accent, c-text colour
- * Rate-limit banner: amber strip, dismissible, 5s auto-hide
- * Toast: bottom-right, white card, sage/amber/red border by type

Screen 2 -- AI Chat Panel

Message Thread

- * c-bg background, 24px padding, flex column, 16px gap
- * Bot: left-aligned, c-surface bubble, 4px top-left radius (speech corner)
- * User: right-aligned, sage tint bubble, 4px top-right radius
- * Font: 14px DM Sans 400, 1.6 line-height, 12px/16px padding

Mood Chip Colours

- * Crisis: rgba(192,57,43,0.12) fill, c-crisis text
- * Negative moods: amber tint fill, c-amber text
- * Neutral/positive: sage tint fill, c-accent text
- * Calm: lavender tint fill, c-lavender text

Wellness Tip Card

- * rgba(61,122,95,0.06) fill, 1px rgba(61,122,95,0.20) border, 10px radius
- * 3px left accent rule in c-accent, tip heading in c-accent 10px 600
- * Tip text: 13px DM Sans 400, c-text, 1.5 line-height

Screen 3 -- Mood Tracking Panel

- * Stat row: two white cards, DM Serif Display 36px numerals

- * Chart: 120px height, c-surface card, sage bars, amber peak
- * Check-in: 6 emoji options, 2px c-accent ring on selected
- * Submit: full-width sage, 12px radius, 14px DM Sans 600

Screen 4 -- Therapy Finder Panel

- * Search: white, 12px radius, sage focus ring, amber icon
- * Active filter: sage fill, white text, no border
- * Card: white, 20px radius, shadow-sm at rest, shadow-md hover, -4px lift
- * Rating: amber star SVG + DM Mono numeral

Screen 5 -- Booking Modal

- * Overlay: rgba(26,25,23,0.45), 6px blur
- * Modal: white, 24px radius, shadow-md, 520px max-width
- * Focus ring: 2px c-accent, 2px offset -- visible, instant
- * Error: c-crisis border + 12px c-crisis text + aria-describedby
- * Entry: translateY(24px to 0) + opacity 0 to 1, 300ms ease-out

Interaction and Motion Design

All animations serve a purpose -- state, feedback, or attention guidance. No purely decorative motion. All transitions respect prefers-reduced-motion.

INTERACTION	ANIMATION	DURATION	EASING
Panel switch	Fade + 8px translateY	220ms	ease-out
Card hover lift	translateY(-4px) + shadow escalation	200ms	ease-out
Modal open	translateY(24px to 0) + opacity 0 to 1	300ms	ease-out
Modal close	opacity 1 to 0	180ms	ease-in
Bot message appear	opacity 0 to 1 + translateY(8px to 0)	280ms	ease-out
Typing indicator	3 dots staggered Y bounce, 6px amplitude	1.2s loop	ease-in-out
Mood bar fill	Width 0 to target + colour lerp	800ms	ease
Toast	slideUp 16px + opacity	280ms / 200ms	ease-out
Send button	scale(0.95) active, scale(1.04) hover	120ms	ease
Focus ring	2px sage outline, 2px offset -- instant	0ms	none

- prefers-reduced-motion Rule**
- * All transitions must be inside @media (prefers-reduced-motion: no-preference).
 - * Under reduced-motion: all transitions set to 0ms.
 - * Typing indicator becomes static ellipsis text under reduced-motion.
 - * This is WCAG 2.1 SC 2.3.3 -- not optional.

Accessibility and Internationalisation

REQUIREMENT	STANDARD	IMPLEMENTATION
Colour contrast	WCAG AA 4.5:1	All text/bg combos verified. Muted text 5.1:1.
Keyboard navigation	WCAG 2.1 SC 2.1.1	Full tab order, Enter/Space on interactive elements, Esc closes modals
Focus indicators	WCAG SC 2.4.7	2px sage outline, 2px offset, visible on all states
ARIA roles	WAI-ARIA 1.1	role=dialog, aria-modal, aria-labelledby, aria-live on chat
Screen reader	WCAG SC 1.1.1	All icon-only buttons have aria-label. Mood emojis labelled.
Form labels	WCAG SC 1.3.1	Explicit label for associations -- no placeholder-only labels
Error messages	WCAG SC 1.3.3	aria-describedby links inputs to error message divs
Reduced motion	WCAG SC 2.3.3	All animations gated on prefers-reduced-motion
Font size min	WCAG SC 1.4.4	Minimum 12px rendered. Rem-based sizing throughout.

Internationalisation Phase 1 Constraints

- * v2.0 ships English only -- i18n architecture deferred.
- * All strings defined in a single constants file, no hardcoded UI strings.
- * Font stack must include Devanagari for Phase 2 language expansion.
- * RTL support (Arabic, Hebrew) deferred to Phase 3.
- * Indian crisis numbers (iCall, Vandrevala, NIMHANS) remain fixed in v2.0.

Security Architecture (Preserved)

Non-Negotiable Security Constraint

- * The entire OWASP mitigation layer from v1.x is preserved verbatim in v2.0.
- * The visual redesign must not alter, remove, or weaken any security control.
- * Engineers implementing the redesign must treat the security module as read-only.
- * CSP, rate limiting, allowlists, and XSS mitigations are locked.

CONTROL	OWASP CATEGORY	STATUS IN v2.0
API key server-side only	A02 Cryptographic Failures	Preserved -- no client-side key
CSP sha256 hash	A05 Security Misconfiguration	Preserved -- recomputed on each script edit
Token-bucket rate limiter	A04 Resource Consumption	Preserved -- fail-closed on unknown action types
InputValidator schemas	A03 Injection	Preserved -- all inputs validated before use
escapeHTML + el() DOM factory	A03 XSS	Preserved -- SAFE_TAGS and SAFE_ATTRS allowlists
Prompt injection defence	A03 LLM Injection	Preserved -- PROMPT_LABEL_ALLOWLIST + sanitizeForPrompt()
TOCTOU guard (currentTherapist)	A04 Logic Flaw	Preserved -- re-validated at confirmation time
ALLOWED_FIELD_IDS	A03 Second-order Injection	Preserved -- fieldId validated before ID construction
quickSend exact match	A03 Injection	Preserved -- exact equality not prefix match
ALLOWED_TOAST_TYPES	A03 CSS Class Injection	Preserved -- type validated before className assignment

Technical Constraints

Implementation Format

- * v2.0 remains a single-file HTML application (no build tool required).
- * All CSS and JS remain inline -- no external bundles.
- * Google Fonts: DM Serif Display, DM Sans, DM Mono via link tag.
- * No CSS frameworks -- vanilla CSS with custom properties only.
- * No JS frameworks -- vanilla ES2020+, no third-party dependencies.
- * Must pass node --check with zero syntax errors.

Browser Support

BROWSER	MIN VERSION	NOTES
Chrome / Edge	95+	Primary target -- full feature support
Firefox	94+	Full support -- verify CSS grid and custom properties
Safari / iOS	15+	Avoid webkit-prefix properties where possible
Samsung Internet	16+	Common browser among Indian Android users

Performance Budget

METRIC	TARGET	RATIONALE
First Contentful Paint	< 1.5s	Single-file, no JS bundle parsing delay
Total file size	< 180 KB	Current ~130KB -- 50KB headroom for new CSS
Font load impact	< 40 KB	DM font family, Latin + Devanagari subset
Animation frame rate	60 fps	Use transform + opacity only -- no layout-triggering props
Time to Interactive	< 2.0s	No blocking scripts, fonts are display:swap

CSS Architecture

- * All design tokens as CSS custom properties on :root, no magic numbers.
- * Naming: --c-{name} colour, --space-{n} spacing, --radius-{name} radius.
- * BEM-lite class naming: .chat-bubble, .chat-bubble--user, .chat-bubble--bot.
- * No !important -- specificity via selector depth only.
- * Dark mode via prefers-color-scheme -- tokens redefined, no class toggling.

* Scrollbar: scrollbar-width: thin, scrollbar-color with c-border token.

Success Metrics and KPIs

Design Quality Gates

Each gate is objectively verifiable. All P0 gates must pass before ship.

GATE	REQUIREMENT	VERIFICATION	PRIORI TY
Accessibility	Zero WCAG AA failures on all screens	Axe DevTools + manual keyboard test	P0
Security	All v1.x security checks pass unchanged	Re-run audit checks against v2.0 build	P0
Syntax	node --check passes with zero errors	Automated CI step on every commit	P0
CSP hash	sha256 matches actual script block	Automated hash verification script	P0
Contrast ratios	All combos >= 4.5:1 body, >= 3:1 large	WebAIM Contrast Checker per token pair	P0
Performance	FCP < 1.5s, TTI < 2s, file < 180KB	Lighthouse, 3G throttle, cold cache	P1
Reduced motion	All animations off under reduced-motion	Chrome DevTools: emulate CSS media	P1
Feature parity	100% of v1.x features present and functional	Manual QA checklist against F1-F5	P0

Post-Launch User Experience KPIs

KPI	BASELINE	v2.0 TARGET	MEASUREMENT
Comfort score	Not measured	>= 4.0 / 5.0	Post-session in-app survey
Session length	Not measured	+20% vs v1.x	Analytics event timestamps
Mood check-in rate	Not measured	+30% vs v1.x	submitCheckin() call count
Booking completion	Not measured	>= 60% open-to-confirm	confirmBooking / openSchedule ratio
A11y complaints	Unknown	0 critical issues	Feedback channel + automated scans

Document Revision History

* v1.0 (Feb 2026) -- Initial PRD for MindEase v2.0 redesign. Covers all 5 features, full design system, motion spec, accessibility requirements, security constraints, and success metrics.

* Future revisions: dark mode token spec, mobile breakpoints, Phase 2 language expansion.

MindEase -- Product Requirements Document / v1.0 / February 2026 / Confidential